

D339 Task 1 Sample (WGM2)

Below you will find a sample response to the Task 1 Explainer Blog Post implementing MFA at a fictional company (Acme University) written by your D339 Instructor Team. Due to concerns with Academic Integrity, we encourage selecting a different focus for your tasks in this course.

Section A: Blog Post

Cybercrimes are increasing. Microsoft reports its systems are attacked over 1000 times per second, and more than 99.9% of the accounts that are compromised do not use Multi-Factor Authentication (Ozsahan & Worthington, 2025). Research suggests that Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) will benefit Acme University because it will make our system more secure. This blog will first describe what MFA is and its features, and second, it will explain why adopting MFA is beneficial to Acme University.

Currently, Acme University uses Single Factor Authentication (SFA) to secure its systems and data. Students, faculty, and staff log in to the Acme system by providing a username and password. However, this is the weakest form of authentication because passwords can be discovered and/or stolen by cybercriminals (Delinea, n.d.). MFA improves security significantly because it requires users to provide something they know, something they have, and something they are (Mathew, 2025). For example, an employee would access the Acme University system by providing a pin or password along with their username (something they know), authentication of account access on a smartphone (something they have), and their thumbprints (something they are). Adding 2 more layers of security to the standard username and password has reduced hacks on the Microsoft system by 99.9% (Mathew, 2025). Improved security is a significant benefit to Acme University.

MFA also reduces security breaches through phishing attempts because cybercriminals may be able to discover passwords, but they will not have access to the thumbprint. Additionally, the legitimate account holders will receive cell phone notifications of unauthorized attempts to access their accounts (Mathew, 2025). This is a major benefit to Acme because it

makes it far harder for hackers to gain access to the system by breaking the password code.

MFA is a direct benefit to students at Acme University. Because Acme receives funding from the US Department of Education, it must follow regulations defined in the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA). Students are guaranteed privacy and confidentiality through this act (United States Department of Education Student Privacy Policy Office, 2023). Acme cannot share student information without permission from the student. If a data breach occurs, Acme could be sued for leaking information. Additionally, the university could lose accreditation and/or federal funding. Without accreditation, our degrees lose their value. Without Federal funding, students will not receive financial aid to attend Acme. This would challenge the university's reputation and decrease student enrollment because many students could not afford to attend without federal financial aid. By preventing data breaches, Acme will protect the excellent education we offer, secure the accreditation that tells employers that our students are qualified, and safeguard student access to Federal financial aid. By far the biggest benefit of MFA is it secures our students' trust because they know we are doing everything we can to protect their privacy.

Research suggests that Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) will benefit Acme University because it will make our system more secure. MFA provides multiple layers of security by asking users to provide something they know, something they have, and something they are. With MFA, Acme will safeguard student data, continue to participate in Federal financial aid programs, and avoid costly lawsuits.

Section B: Identify Employee Group

This blog was written for the IT department of Acme University because this is the department that will be the most affected by the change to MFA. Specifically, this would include cybersecurity staff and network engineers. I will need their support to make this change successful.

B1. Analyzing Business Etiquette

I used an informative tone to help teach the IT staff about MFA in a neutral, more objective manner to focus on facts they need about the MFA process and benefits. I used a semi-formal **word choice** that used both first person and contractions because I wanted the blog to be easy to read, but professional. I wanted to show respect and professionalism to these engineers and cybersecurity experts because I will need their support to advocate for and implement MFA.

Section C: Sources

Delinea. (n.d.). Single-factor Authentication (SFA) vs. Multi-factor Authentication (MFA). <https://jumpcloud.com/blog/multi-factor-authentication-statistics>

Mathew, A. (2025, March 17). Will MFA Redefine Cyberdefense in the 21st Century? <https://www.isaca.org/resources/news-and-trends/industry-news/2025/will-mfa-redefine-cyberdefense-in-the-21st-century>

Ozsahan, H & Worthington, D. (2025, April 11). 2025 Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) Statistics & Trends to Know. <https://jumpcloud.com/blog/multi-factor-authentication-statistics>

United States Department of Education Student Privacy Policy Office (2023, March 8). An Eligible Student Guide to the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA). https://studentprivacy.ed.gov/sites/default/files/resource_document/file/An%20Eligible%20Student%20Guide%20to%20FERPA_0.pdf

Section D: Professional Communication

Do **not** provide a response here. Use [Grammarly for Education](#) to check spelling and grammar.